

Creator Tool Audit Checklist

12 questions to cut your tool spend by 30%+ — without losing workflow quality.

12

audit questions

3

decision zones

30%+

avg. savings

PART 1 · THE 12 AUDIT QUESTIONS

For each tool in your stack, answer honestly. Flag anything that triggers a X.

01

When did I last actually open and use this tool?

☐

Flag if: more than 30 days ago

02

Does this tool have a free tier I'm not using or could switch to?

☐

Flag if: yes, and the free tier covers my needs

03

Am I paying for a team or business plan but using it solo?

☐

Flag if: yes — downgrade to individual plan

04

Is there a free or cheaper alternative that does 80% of what I need?

☐

Flag if: yes — Figma vs Canva, Notion vs Obsidian, etc.

05

Do I use this tool's core feature weekly, or did I just plan to?

☐

Flag if: you planned to but haven't yet

06

Am I on an annual plan for something I use infrequently?

☐

Flag if: monthly usage but annual billing

07

Could another tool I already pay for do this job instead?

☐

Flag if: overlap exists — consolidate and cancel one

08

Does this tool make me money, save real time, or just feel productive?

☐

Flag if: it only 'feels' productive but has no ROI

09

Am I in a free trial that will auto-renew that I haven't reviewed?

☐

Flag if: yes — set a calendar reminder to cancel or convert

10

Have I used this tool's core feature in the last 90 days?

☐

Flag if: no — serious cancellation candidate

11

Would I pay for this tool again if I had to sign up fresh today?

☐

Flag if: hesitation = strong cancel signal

12

Have I claimed all available discounts? (student, creator, annual)

☐

Flag if: no — check the tool's pricing page for deals

COLOUR LEGEND:



Amber — Review & decide



X Red — Strong cancel / downgrade signal



Green — Keep (used on page 2)

Part 2 — Decision Framework & Budget Template

Use your flagged answers from Part 1 to place each tool below, then set your monthly budget targets.

PART 2A · KEEP / AUDIT / CANCEL MATRIX

KEEP ✓

0–1 flags · Used weekly · Clear ROI

eg. Adobe Premiere

eg. Figma

Est. monthly cost:

AUDIT ■

2–3 flags · Occasional use · Unclear value

Est. monthly cost:

CANCEL ✕

4+ flags · Rarely used · No clear ROI

Est. monthly cost:

PART 2B · MONTHLY BUDGET TARGET BY CATEGORY

Category	Common tools	Budget	Actual
Creative Tools	Adobe, Canva, Figma, DALL-E...		
Editing & Audio	Descript, Premiere, DaVinci...		
AI & Productivity	ChatGPT, Notion, Obsidian...		
Hosting & Storage	Google Drive, Dropbox, AWS...		
Music & SFX	Epidemic Sound, Artlist...		
Marketing & Email	ConvertKit, Buffer, Beehiiv...		
TOTAL MONTHLY SPEND			

PART 2C · THE 3 GOLDEN RULES

Rule 1:

If you haven't opened a tool in 30 days, cancel it. You won't miss it.

Rule 2:

Never pay for a team plan solo. Always check if an individual tier exists.

Rule 3:

One tool per job. Overlapping tools = wasted money. Pick one and commit.

Track your full creator stack at [subtrackus.com](#)

Add all your tools, see your real monthly burn, and know exactly what to cut.
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